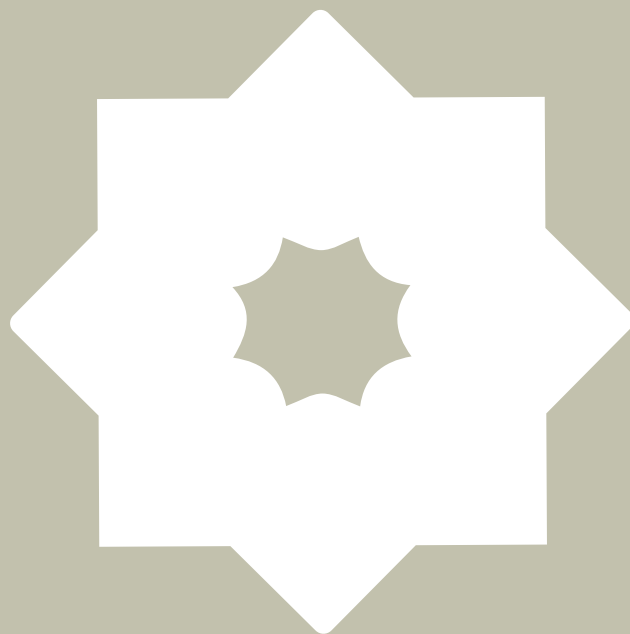


AKRILLE

CUTRERA BASTIANICH

story of a destiny

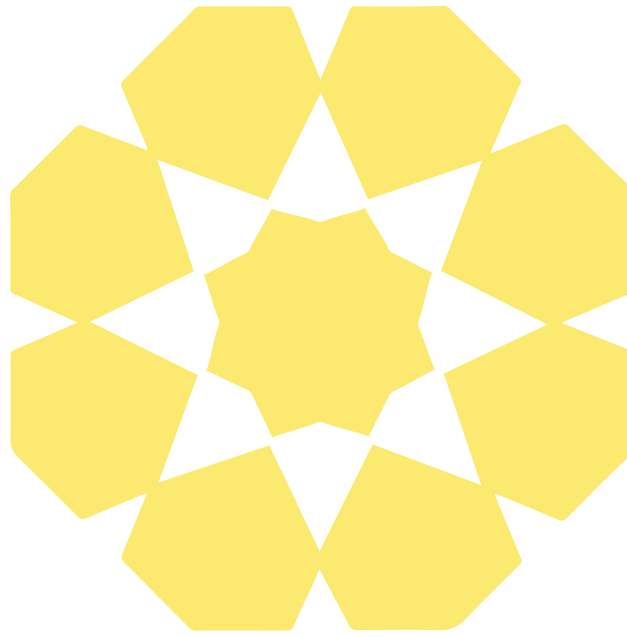


AKRILLE, 3000 YEARS OF HISTORY

The name *Akrille* represents a deep connection with the ancient origins of Chiaramonte Gulfi, passing through all dominations. Akrille was originally a Greek settlement dating back to 600 b.C., which experienced moments of splendor and tragedy. In 200 b.C. the settlement was conquered by the Romans, becoming Akrille Romana, who contributed to its growth and prosperity.

However, Akrille's history was also marked by tragic moments, such as when it was conquered by the Arabs in 500 a.C. and renamed Gulfi. The name Chiaramonte Gulfi comes from Count Manfredi Chiaramonte, who founded the town in 1300, naming it after his own lineage, after the Angevins destroyed Gulfi in 1299. Gulfi would eventually be added to the municipality's official name only in 1881.

Today, with our wines, we are once again bringing the story of Akrille to light.



CUTRERA FAMILY OIL, WINE & PALMENTO

The cutrera family, famous worldwide for the production of extra virgin olive oil since 1906.

In addition to their historic cultivation of olives, Cutrera family also owned one of the most important Palmento for the production of must and wine in the Chiaramonte Gulfi area. They also had an old historic vineyard planted by great-grandfather Salvatore. The activity of the Palmento, regularly recognized in Sicily, was certainly one of the trades practiced only on the island for centuries and generations. Grape cultivation and wine production have always been practiced here, but it was actually the French who, in the late 19th century, came to Sicily to encourage grape cultivation, as phylloxera had destroyed all the French vineyards.

Thanks to this high demand, Palmento were established in Sicily, transforming grapes into must within 48 hours of fermentation, then selling the produced must to the French, who would then ship it to France. This thriving activity, however, began to decline around the 1980s when the French became self-sufficient once again. The family maintained the activity until 2014. That year, with the passing of Giovanni Cutrera and the generational change, the tradition of having their own wine at home basically disappeared, along with the Palmento activity.

BASTIANICH FAMILY

It is undeniable that Italian food and wine have always had a strong cultural connection to the Bastianich family's roots and history.

Pioneers in importing excellent Italian wines to the United States since the early 70s, they eventually became producers in 1997 in the DOC Friuli Colli Orientali with the Bastianich Winery in Cividale del Friuli.

The family's story begins in Istria, a peninsula on the northeastern coast of the Adriatic Sea, once Italian territory and now divided between Slovenia and Croatia. The years following World War II were not easy for the Bastianich family, leading Mrs. Erminia, Joe's maternal grandmother, to flee from Tito's regime, seeking a better future for her family.

They spent two years in the Risiera di San Sabba refugee camp in Trieste under challenging conditions before finding work and acceptance in New York. There, they tried to recreate what they had left behind, with the few belongings and memories they carried with them.

Among homemade wine demijohns, cured meats, and a garden rich in radicchio, pumpkins, fruit trees, and everything that reminded them of *home*. Felice and Lidia Bastianich, parents of *Restaurant Man* Joe Bastianich, opened their first restaurant in 1971, *Buonavia* in Queens, followed by *Villasecondo* and, in 1981, by *Felidia* in Manhattan, which soon became the temple of true traditional and regional Italian cuisine in the Big Apple.

Once grown, Joe spent a sabbatical year in Italy, working in the cellars and vineyards of the greatest producers of the time (and beyond!) and a year in Palermo at the Micieli Company. After planting vineyards in Pantelleria, learning the basics of the wine world from North to South Italy, harvesting in Montalcino and Bolgheri, Joe returned to NY to open his first restaurant. His path has led him today to manage more than twenty restaurants worldwide, as well as entrepreneurial projects related to the Italian food world such as *Eataly United States*, and a television, authorial, and musical career that spans between Italy and the USA.

Joe wanted to buy, with his family, the first vineyards in Italy at the birth of his firstborn, Olivia, because he wanted his children to finally — after so many years — have a place in Italy they could call *home*, starting from an area suited to great whites. Today, the Bastianich Winery produces around 230,000 bottles per year, exported to more than 28 countries.





FRIENDSHIP, HISTORY & PRIMO OIL

Joe Bastianich was the first person to open a bottle of Cutrera oil in 1999. The entrepreneurial story of the *Frantoi Cutrera* brand began in 1999 with the European Union's recognition of the PDO Monti Iblei, which first perceived the potential of the Iblea round olive. In 1999, *Frantoi Cutrera* was the first and only company to produce oil with the controlled designation of origin PDO Monti Iblei, which is also one of the reasons for choosing the name *Primo*.

WINE IDEA

In 2019, during a dinner in New York, specially after a couple of bottles of wine and tequila, Joe was fascinated by the story of the Cutrera family which has been connected to wine for six generations. That evening, the idea of *Cutrera-Bastianich* was born.



PHILOSOPHY, TERROIR & WINEYARDS

The philosophy of this new and fresh company is based on territoriality and traditions. Wines will be produced only from native grapes, seeking out the oldest clones. Sicily has a particular microclimate, and thanks to the influence of Etna and the prevailing winds on each slope, completely different microzones have been created.

We have studied the territory extensively and carefully evaluated the production areas, especially considering climate change, prolonged drought and rising temperatures. We decided to plant our new vineyards between 500 and 600 metres above sea level, on a mixed terrain of clay, limestone and stones, facing southeast and southwest, only 50 km from mount Etna. We will have a unique land where the temperature fluctuations between day and night will give our wines unique organoleptic properties.

WINE IN THE DESTINY & CUTRERA GRAPE VARIETY

The Cutrera family has always owned an old historic vineyard, cared for by various generations. This vineyard was planted by great-grandfather Salvatore (*Zu Turi*) and had a peculiarity: it was made up of a mix of grape varieties. Around 2000, the Sicilian region began a search to find relic grape varieties that survived phylloxera or grape varieties that had disappeared.

In our vineyard, researchers identified two particular grape varieties, a white and a red one. The red is an old clone of Nero d'Avola, very particular but almost abandoned because it was not as productive as the new strains.

The white, on the other hand, is unpublished, not connected to any grape variety; the only specimens were in our vineyard. This *Cutrera* grape variety was bred at the Regional Center for Viticultural and Agricultural Biodiversity and Viticultural Unit of Marsala, and some companies are already experimenting with it. We discovered this incredible story in September 2023 only after the company's formation: therefore, we will be a company with a white family grape variety and a *unique* Nero d'Avola.

OUR WINES

Grillo SICILIA DOC

Frappato VITTORIA DOC

Cerasuolo di Vittoria DOCG

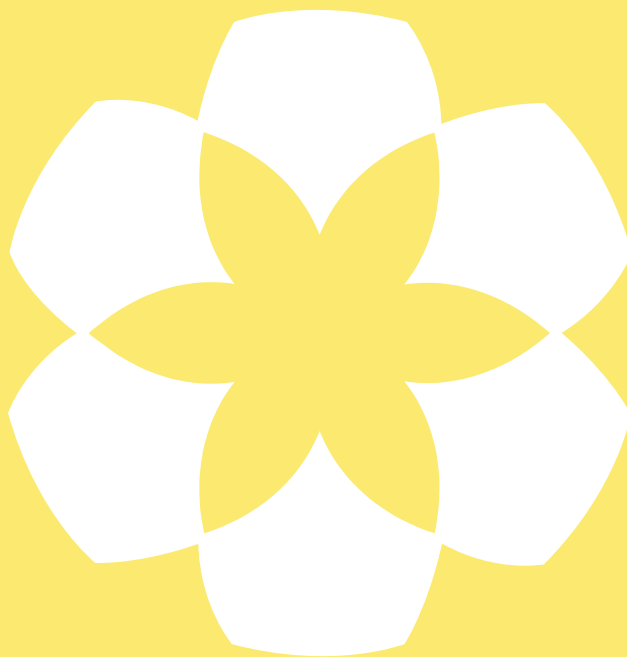
Frabolla BRUT FRAPPATO ROSÉ

Cerasuolo di Vittoria CLASSICO

Nero d'Avola SICILIA DOC

Catarratto Lucido SICILIA DOC





WINERY

The winery was born in Chiaramonte Gulfi, where the old Palmento of the Cutrera family stood, and where the old equipment is still installed.

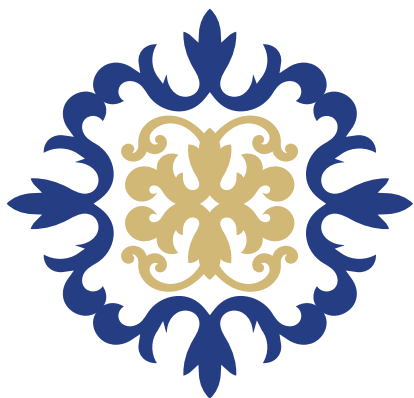
The position of Chiaramonte Gulfi is strategic for wine production: it is located in the heart of the Cerasuolo di Vittoria DOCC, the only Sicilian DOCC, just 60 km as the crow flies from Etna. A central point for our production areas.

TEAM

The newly formed company is composed of an important team of professionals in all areas: a fusion between the *Bastianich* winery and *Frantoi Cutrera*, with decades of experience in food & beverage.

We have also formed a mixed team of important local winemakers, such as Peppe Romano, the historic winemaker of the Cutrera family, with the contribution of external experience from Emilio del Medico, who was already a winemaker for the Bastianich family





AKRILLE
CUTRERA BASTIANICH



CERASUOLO DI VITTORIA CLASSICO DOCG



Nero d'Avola and Frappato

Maturation

The grapes, well ripened and selected in the vineyard, are harvested in the first decade of October. Frappato and Nero D'Avola undergo red vinification with maceration on the skins for about 20 to 30 days in steel tanks at a controlled temperature between 22 and 27 °C. A portion follows maturation in French oak tonneaux for about 8 months, followed by maturation in steel for an additional 10 months or so. It is then bottled and placed in bottle ageing for about six months.

Tasting notes

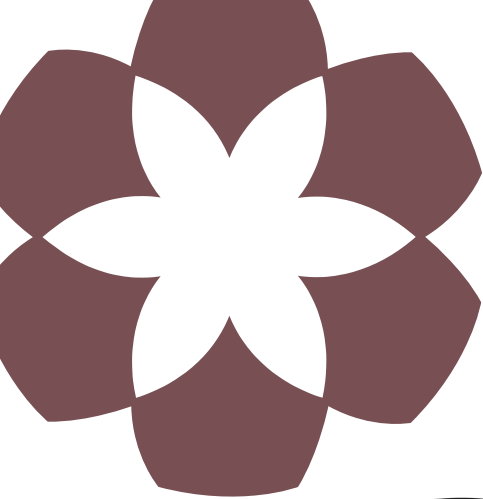
Intense cherry red color with purple highlights. Our Cerasuolo di Vittoria Classico DOCG presents fruity notes on the nose, with hints of blueberry, morello cherry and blackberry, with an undertone of licorice. The taste is full, warm and enveloping, with notes of red fruits and a long finish persistence. A well-structured, complete and balanced wine.

Pairing

Ideal with red meats, game and aged cheeses such as Ragusano DOP. A serving temperature of 18 to 20 °C is recommended.

The data, analysis and descriptions highlighted in each sheet are merely indicative of the average product characteristics and therefore not referring to each specific vintage.





AKRILLE

CUTRERA BASTIANICH

CERASUOLO DI VITTORIA DOCG



Nero d'Avola and Frappato

Maturation

The grapes, well ripened and selected in the vineyard, are harvested between the second and third decade of September. Frappato and Nero D'Avola undergo red vinification with maceration on the skins for about 15 to 20 days in steel tanks at a controlled temperature between 22 and 27 °C. Maturation in steel for about 8 months follows, after which the wine is bottled to rest for about four months.

Tasting notes

Cherry red color with purplish highlights. Our Cerasuolo di Vittoria DOCG presents fruity notes on the nose, with hints of blueberry, morello cherry and blackberry. The taste is full, soft and enveloping, with notes of red fruits and a long finish persistence.

Pairing

Ideal with red meats, game and aged cheeses such as Ragusano DOP. A serving temperature of 18 to 20 °C is recommended.

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AKRILLE

CUTRERA BASTIANICH

VITTORIA DOC FRAPPATO



Frappato

Maturation

The grapes, which are well ripened and selected in the vineyard, are harvested in the third decade of September and conducted in temperature-controlled steel fermentation tanks. The wine undergoes maceration on the skins for about 15 - 20 days at a controlled temperature between 18 and 22 °C. Maturation in steel for about 5 months follows, after which the wine is bottled to rest for about two months.

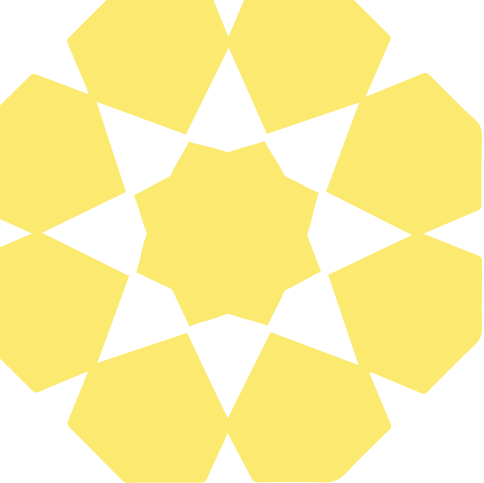
Tasting notes

Brilliant cherry red color. Our Frappato has floral notes on the nose, of slightly wilted flowers, aromas of spices and small red fruits, such as blueberries, wild strawberries and blackberries. On the palate, the tannin is fine and spicy and fragrant elements emerge, with a resumption of red fruits.

Pairing

Ideal with cured meats, fatty or raw fish dishes and with fresh cheeses. A serving temperature of 14 to 16 °C is recommended.

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AKRILLE

CUTRERA BASTIANICH

SICILIA DOC GRILLO



Grillo

Maturation

The grapes, which are well ripened and selected in the vineyard, are harvested in the last decade of August and led into temperature-controlled steel fermentation tanks. After a short carbonic maceration and alcoholic fermentation at a controlled temperature between 15 and 18 °C, a maturation of about 5 months in steel follows. The wine is placed on the market following bottle ageing of about 2 months.

Tasting notes

Straw yellow colour with greenish highlights. Our Grillo presents on the nose floral notes, mainly related to white flowers, and citrus notes. On the palate, elements of distinct sapidity and minerality emerge. The finish is long and pleasant, with an aftertaste of pear, pineapple and jasmine.

Pairing

Ideal with fried fish or vegetables, white meats and fresh cheeses. A serving temperature of 12 to 16 °C is recommended.



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AKRILLE

CUTRERA BASTIANICH

SICILIA DOC CATARRATTO LUCIDO



Catarratto Lucido

Maturation

The grapes, which are well ripened and selected in the vineyard, are harvested between the first ten days of August and the firsts of September. After soft pressing, fermentation is carried out in steel tanks for about 15 - 20 days at a controlled temperature between 12 and 15 °C. Maturation in steel for about 2 months follows, after which the wine is bottled to rest for another couple of months.

Tasting notes

Bright straw yellow colour. On the nose it releases hints of fruit, apricots and white-fleshed peaches enriched by orange blossoms. Full-bodied taste with strong sapidity and minerality.

Pairing

Ideal with fish based dishes as well as fried fish, but also white meat and fresh cheese. A serving temperature of 12 to 14 °C is recommended.



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AKRILLE

CUTRERA BASTIANICH

SICILIA DOC NERO D'AVOLA



Nero d'Avola

Maturation

The grapes, well ripened and selected in the vineyard, are harvested between the last decade of September and the first decade of October. Our Nero D'Avola undergoes red vinification with maceration on the skins for about 10 to 15 days in steel tanks at a controlled temperature between 25 and 28 °C. Maturation in steel for about 6 months follows, after which the wine is bottled to rest for about four months.

Tasting notes

Intense ruby red color. Our Nero D'Avola presents fruity notes on the nose, with hints of plum and morello cherry among all. On the palate the body of the wine gives life to full, warm sensations, but well balanced by the lively and sweet tannic part. The finish is pleasant with hints of berry and cherry.

Pairing

Ideal with a meat stew, roast beef and with aged Ragusano PDO cheese. A serving temperature of 16 to 18 °C is recommended.



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CUTRERA BASTIANICH

FRABOLLA

BRUT FRAPPATO ROSÉ



Frappato

Maturation

The Frappato grapes, harvested towards the end of August and collected in crates, are subsequently vinified as white grapes, with only destemming and gentle pressing. After preparing the base wine, a natural secondary fermentation takes place in an autoclave between 10 and 12 °C for approximately 12 to 20 days. Once the residual sugar content and the desired pressure are reached, the temperature is suddenly lowered to stop the fermentation. After maturing on the lees for approximately 2 - 3 months, the wine is filtered and bottled.

Tasting notes

Pale pink, our Brut Frappato Rosé is a light and irresistible wine. On the nose, it presents floral and aromatic notes, with hints of wild strawberry, cherry and raspberry, balanced by aromas of flowers, Mediterranean herbs and light spices. On the palate, our Frappato is fresh and elegant, with a pleasant acidity which invites you to the next sip, where spiced and fragrant elements emerge, with a red fruits final.

Pairing

Perfect for aperitifs and to pair with fish-based entrees as well as shellfishes and cured meat from the Ragusa area. A serving temperature of 6 to 8 °C is recommended.

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This adventure has a dream:
to excite people and shape a story that can defy time.

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